

Special Licence: Project application form



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Definitions

Licence holder: the licence holder(s) specified in section 1.

Data depositor: depositor of the studies detailed in section 2.3.

Data: the special licence study numbers detailed in section 2.3.

Dispute arbitrator: The Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC).

How to complete this form

This application form should be completed by the project lead. The project lead will be the single point of contact for the UK Data Service in relation to this project both at the application stage, and through the full lifetime of the project. The project lead will be contacted with reminders about project expiries, and must submit any extension requests, or requests to vary the project or project team members.

For a research project being undertaken by academics the project lead **does not** have to be the Principal Investigator. Where there is funding associated with a project the project lead **does not** have to be the award holder.

Our [example application](#) shows the level of information that data owners expect to see in a well written application.

If more than one person is involved in the project and will have access to the data your are applying for, list them in section 1.2 and ensure **each additional** team member completes the Special Licence additional researcher form.

Only list individuals who **will see the raw data** in Section 1.2.

If you are a student conducting research related to your studies your supervisor **only** needs to be listed in Section 1.2 if they will be consulting the raw data.

We recommend the project lead liaises with all project team members to finalise the project details and ensures all necessary documentation is gathered before submitting to the UK Data Service by email to help@ukdataservice.ac.uk.

The project lead and **all** individuals listed in Section 1.2 must **also** complete and submit a signed UK Data Service Special Licence User Agreement.

1. About your project

UK Data Service project number <i>This is found on your UK Data Service account</i>	282609
Project title	Work from home in the UK
Project start date <i>When do you want to start working with the data?</i>	07/05/2026
Project end date <i>When do you plan to complete your project work?</i>	
Is your project funded? <i>Funding is not mandatory but provides additional reassurance for the project</i>	No
If yes, which organisation/institution is funding the research?	

Project lead/project team details:

1.1 Project lead

Please list the details of the project lead as listed on the UK Data Service website.

First name(s)	Itay
Surname	Saporta Eksten
Institution/Organisation	University of Manchester
Institution/Organisation address	The University of Manchester Oxford Road Manchester M13 9PL
Telephone number	07707784380

Email <i>This must be the email address associated with your UK Data Service user account</i>	itay.saportaeksten@manchester.ac.uk
Location of access <i>Please state the site of access for the project lead. Include the address of where the data will be hosted and stored, including your organisation/institution name</i>	Data will be stored and processed on a secure desktop computer located in a locked office at: The Eitan Berglas School of Economics Tel Aviv University, Ramat Aviv 6997801 ISRAEL The data will be accessed remotely by me via Tel Aviv University's secure VPN system from the following locations: The University of Manchester Oxford Road Manchester M13 9PL My home office: 14 Victoria rd. London N22 7XB The data will be accessed remotely by the research student via Tel Aviv University's secure VPN system from the following locations: The Eitan Berglas School of Economics Tel Aviv University, Ramat Aviv 6997801 ISRAEL His home office at: 140 Arlozorov st., Tel Aviv-Yaffo, 6209821 Israel

Measures in place to protect the data <i>Refer to section 4.1.1 (on page 8) of the Research data handling and security guide for users when completing this section.</i>	The data will be stored and processed on a Tel Aviv university-managed desktop computer located in a locked office at Tel Aviv University. Access to the data will be limited to approved project members and will be conducted remotely via Tel Aviv University's secure VPN using personal user accounts with two-factor authentication. Remote access sessions will be initiated only when required and will be closed when not in use. No data will be stored on personal laptops, external drives, or cloud storage services. All processing will take place on the institutional computer, and no data will be downloaded or transferred outside the secure environment. The institutional computer is encrypted (BitLocker) and protected by password authentication. The system is configured to automatically lock after a short period of inactivity and requires authentication to regain access. The system receives regular security updates and is protected by anti-malware software. At the end of the project, all data will be securely deleted in accordance with UK Data Service requirements.
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Please note: Home working access is available for some Special Licence data, see [Special Licence home working arrangements](#), and the list of studies approved for home working access. If home working access is required, complete the Appendix of the Special Licence User Agreement.

1.2 Research team

In addition to the project lead details given above, please list the names and email address of all member(s) of your research team who **will access** the data.

- All researchers listed below should be invited to the project on the [UK Data Service website](https://ukdataservice.ac.uk).
- Each person listed below will need to complete a Special Licence additional researcher form **and** a Special Licence User Agreement.

Name	Email address
Ori Nahshon Shoham	orishoham@mail.tau.ac.il

Add additional rows to the table if necessary.

2. Project details

The information you provide here will be used by the data owner to make a decision about whether or not to approve your application to use this data.

2.1 Abstract

Using plain language, without jargon, please include a short description of the project and its benefits.

Gender gaps in earnings and careers remain a central economic and social problem. A central hypothesis is that the division of labour inside the household is the primary cause of those gaps. This project studies whether temporary shocks to household specialization when children are young, at the beginning of parenthood, can durably change the later division of labour within the household, and whether such changes have causal effects on gender gaps in labour market outcomes and parents' career trajectories.

We exploit exogenous variation created by the COVID-19 pandemic, which sharply changed the allocation of paid work and caregiving across couples depending on the pre-pandemic sectors and occupations in which mothers and fathers were employed. We will use a difference-in-differences event study design that determines treatment status based on the pre-COVID sector exposure to COVID regulations.

2.2 Research proposal

Please provide a full and detailed description of the purpose for which the data are requested, describing the aims of the project. Where research is part of a larger programme, please include details below.

This project studies how asymmetric employment shocks within couples affect the intra-household division of labour and gender inequality. The COVID-19 pandemic introduced sector-specific restrictions that affected industries and occupations differently. Because partners are employed in different sectors, households experienced unequal shocks to labour market participation and time spent at home.

The central question is whether pandemic-induced changes in relative exposure, such as one partner continuing to work outside the home while the other experienced shutdowns, furlough, or remote work, altered the division of paid and unpaid work. In particular, we examine whether changes in relative presence at home led to more equal sharing of childcare and domestic responsibilities, whether such changes persisted in the long run, and how they depend on local restrictions associated with the pandemic.

The analysis compares changes in household labour allocation before and after the pandemic across couples with different combinations of sectoral exposure and family composition, and incorporates variation in local COVID-19 restrictions, including school closures. We will study a wide range of outcomes, including employment, working hours, childcare and domestic time, and selected health measures.

2.3 Data required for the project

List the UK Data Service study number and full study title.

In this section you only need to detail Special Licence studies required (data subject to the Special Licence user agreement). For example: [SN 6931 - Understanding Society: Waves 1-14, 2009-2023 and Harmonised BHPS: Waves 1-18, 1991-2009: Special Licence Access](#).

SN 6931 - Understanding Society: Waves 1-15, 2009-2024 and Harmonised BHPS: Waves 1-18, 1991-2009: Special Licence Access

SN 6666 - Understanding Society: Waves 1-15, 2009-2024 and Harmonised BHPS: Waves 1-18, 1991-2009: Special Licence Access, Local Authority District

2.4 Justification

Please provide a justification as to why you are requesting access to the data listed in section 2.3. You should include:

- An explanation as to why you require these data, including information about specific variables or questions of interest and how you'll use these in your research.
- An explanation demonstrating that you have considered alternative sources of data, and reasons why these data are not sufficient for your research.

IMPORTANT: when applying for social survey data, we strongly recommend that you consider using less restrictive versions of the data that are available. Please visit the [UK Data Service catalogue](#) to locate less restrictive sources, where available.

This project requires access to the Special Licence version of Understanding Society in order to obtain detailed industry and occupation identifiers for both partners within households. The empirical design relies on constructing measures of exposure to COVID-19 sectoral restrictions at the industry–occupation level, including classification into sectors subject to shutdowns, essential/key worker sectors requiring work outside the home, and occupations with the capacity to transition to remote work.

To implement this classification, we require access to the full Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) and Standard Occupational Classification (SOC) codes (e.g., jbsic07, jobsoc00) available under the Special Licence. The broader industry and occupation groupings in the End User Licence (EUL) version do not provide sufficient detail to distinguish between sub-sectors that were differentially affected by pandemic restrictions (for example, essential versus non-essential retail, frontline versus non-frontline healthcare, or occupations with differing remote-work feasibility). The detailed codes are therefore necessary to construct accurate exposure measures.

In addition, the project requires Local Authority District identifiers to link households to external data on local COVID-19 restrictions, including school closures. The EUL version provides geographical information only at the Government Office Region level, which is too aggregated to capture this variation. Access to Local Authority identifiers is therefore necessary to construct accurate measures of local policy exposure.

A further key feature of Understanding Society is the ability to link pre-pandemic employment information to the Understanding Society COVID-19 Study waves. This linkage allows us to examine short-term adjustments in employment status, working from home, childcare responsibilities, and health, and to analyse the mechanisms underlying changes in household labour allocation. Alternative UK datasets do not combine detailed couple-level panel data with both employment detail and pandemic-specific survey waves.

We have considered less restrictive data versions and alternative sources; however, the EUL version does not provide sufficient detail in industry, occupation, or geography to implement the proposed design. The Special Licence version is therefore required.

2.5 Does your project proposal include any linking of data sources?

If yes, please provide the following details below:

- A description of the data source(s) to be linked to the data.
- A summary of the key variables.
- A summary of the linking methodology.
- Justification for the linking.

The project will link Understanding Society data to the Institute for Fiscal Studies (IFS) COVID-19 Restrictions Dataset, which provides detailed information on the timing and intensity of local policy measures in the UK, including school closures, restrictions on economic activity, and social distancing measures at the Local Authority District level.

Key variables from this dataset include indicators of primary and secondary school closures, as well as measures of restrictions affecting workplaces and social interactions. These variables vary over time and across Local Authorities.

Linkage will be conducted using Local Authority District identifiers available in the Special Licence version of Understanding Society. Households will be matched to the corresponding Local Authority, and policy variables will be assigned based on the timing of the interview.

This linkage is necessary to incorporate variation in local policy environments into the analysis and to examine how differences in school closures and other restrictions affected intra-household labour allocation.

2.6 Expected outputs

Please give details of the products/outputs that will be produced from your use of the data. This might include things like: analysis, reports, tables, journal articles, books, chapters, blog posts or theses. If applicable, please describe the impact and public benefit which you expect will occur as a result of your use of the data.

The primary outputs of this project will be empirical analysis of changes in intra-household labour allocation associated with differential exposure to COVID-19 sectoral restrictions and local policy measures. We will produce statistical estimates of how asymmetric shocks to presence at home within couples affected short and long run outcomes, including employment status, working hours, childcare responsibilities, and domestic work, with particular attention to parents of young children.

The results will be presented in the form of regression estimates, summary tables, and figures. We intend to prepare one or more academic papers for submission to peer-reviewed journals in economics or related social sciences. The findings may also be presented at academic conferences and seminars.

By providing evidence on whether temporary gender role reversals can alter patterns of household labour division, the project aims to contribute to policy discussions on gender equality, family policy, and labour market resilience in response to large economic disruptions.

2.7 Protection of confidentiality

Describe the methods you will use to determine whether the outputs listed in Section 2.6 above are disclosive and the measures you will use to protect confidentiality in those outputs.

Methods and standards specified in the [Research data handling and security guide for users](#) and [Office for National Statistics's Disclosure control for tables produced from surveys](#) must be applied to statistical outputs.

All analysis will comply with the UK Data Service Research Data Handling and Security: Guide for Users and the Office for National Statistics guidance on disclosure control for survey data outputs.

The detailed industry, occupation, and geographical variables accessed under the Special Licence will be used to construct categorical exposure indicators and as well as for heterogeneity analysis. No outputs will include disaggregated SIC or SOC classifications or detailed geographical identifiers beyond broad analytical groupings necessary for interpretation.

We will not report tabulations or summary statistics based on small cells. Where necessary, categories will be aggregated to prevent disclosure risk. No outputs will identify individual respondents, households, employers, or small geographic areas.

Regression results will report coefficients, standard errors, and overall sample sizes. No individual-level data will be shared. All outputs will consist solely of aggregated statistical summaries that comply with applicable disclosure control standards.

www.ukdataservice.ac.uk

help@ukdataservice.ac.uk

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